

Microsoft 365 Copilot Analytics

Attribute Reference

Complete attribute mapping, data classification, and naming conventions for organisational data

Document Property	Value
Section	Reference
Audience	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Version	4.2
Last validated	2 October 2026

How This Document Fits

This is a **Reference** guide. Use it when preparing CSV uploads or configuring HRIS connectors. For the step-by-step upload process, see the Data Onboarding Guide.

Section	Purpose	Who Reads
Strategy	Decide what to implement	CIO, SA, Business Leaders
Setup	Configure and deploy	IT Admin, Insights Admin
Operate	Use dashboards and reports daily	Leaders, Analysts, Managers
Reference (you are here)	Look up details and fix issues	Everyone (as needed)

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1. Attribute Mapping Table

This table maps Viva Insights organizational-data names to the **Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service** reserved names used in the Microsoft 365 admin center. Use the names required by the active tenant path and target app; do not infer the path from a date alone.

Legacy Name (Viva Insights)	M365 Admin Center Name	Required?	Description / Notes
PersonId	Microsoft_PersonEmail	Platform required	Employee’s work email used to associate data with a person. This is the single platform-wide required Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service attribute.
ManagerId	Microsoft_ManagerEmail	Required for Viva Insights / Copilot Dashboard	Manager’s email address. Required when sharing data with Viva Insights and the Copilot Dashboard; validate each reporting link and intended root.
Organization	Microsoft_Organization	Required for Viva Insights / Copilot Dashboard	Department or organizational unit. Required when sharing data with Viva Insights and the Copilot Dashboard and used for organization grouping.
EffectiveDate	N/A (date picker in UI)	Tenant-path dependent	Viva upload path: include in the file as documented by the live workflow. Microsoft 365 admin center: remove the column and set File valid as of in the UI; use Historical import for retroactive Viva corrections.

FunctionType	Microsoft_JobDiscipline	Optional	Drives the Job Function filter on the Copilot Dashboard.
LevelDesignation	Microsoft_LevelDesignation	Optional	Enables level-based views and analysis (e.g., IC vs Manager vs Director).
Location	Microsoft_CompanyOfficeLocation	Optional	Drives the Location filter on the Copilot Dashboard.
HireDate	Microsoft_HireDate	Optional	Used for tenure-based analysis and before/after cohort segmentation (format: YYYY-MM-DD).
HourlyRate	Microsoft_HourlyRate	Optional	Confidential. Required for per-employee Assisted Value calculation. Set access classification to Confidential . If not provided, the dashboard uses the global default (\$72/hour).
Layer	Microsoft_Layer	Optional	Hierarchy depth from the top.
SupervisorIndicator	Microsoft_SupervisorIndicator	Optional	Indicates whether the employee is a manager (has direct reports).
Custom (e.g., BusinessUnit)	Custom (same name)	Optional	Up to 105 total attributes (reserved + custom). Use for Agency, Cost Centre, Region, Project, etc.

Source: Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service — requirements (Microsoft Learn, updated 1 September 2026) defines `Microsoft_PersonEmail` as the platform requirement and the app matrix; Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (13 August 2026) defines the three Dashboard/Viva attributes.

2. Requirements and Source Precedence

Surface / attribute	Requirement or precedence	Validation
Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service	Microsoft_PersonEmail is required. Additional attributes depend on the selected apps.	Review the target-app selections and mapping before validation.
Copilot Dashboard and Viva Insights	Microsoft_PersonEmail , Microsoft_ManagerEmail , and Microsoft_Organization are required. Microsoft_JobDiscipline is optional and enables Job function.	Verify hierarchy, Organization, and Job function in Viva data quality and the Dashboard after processing.
Microsoft 365 User Profile	Microsoft Entra is the default source. Uploaded organizational data can be prioritised and can fill gaps where Entra data is missing or incomplete.	Record the Profile precedence setting and spot-check profile cards in Outlook or Teams.
Viva ManagerId and Organization	Parallel ingestion can select Entra as the default for either attribute while uploaded data continues to supply other fields.	Review Configure Entra connection ; allow about 24 hours after a change.
Multiple upload sources	Microsoft documents merged Dashboard data with the more recent upload taking priority.	Record source owner, attribute, selected app, import ID, and timestamp; avoid overlapping unowned sources.

Sources: Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service — Data precedence (Microsoft Learn, updated 1 September 2026); Manage settings for the Microsoft Copilot Dashboard, Agent Dashboard, Consumption Dashboard, and Viva Insights web app (13 August 2026); and Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads (Last updated 7 July 2026).

3. Data Classification

When uploading organisational data, each attribute is assigned an access classification that controls which applications and roles can read the data.

Classification	Visibility	Example Attributes
Public	Well-known organizational attributes made available to Microsoft 365 Profile and accessible to tenant users and Microsoft 365 apps, subject to the platform’s app-sharing and precedence behavior.	Organization , Location , LevelDesignation
Confidential	Sensitive well-known attributes for which the uploader chooses the apps that can receive the data.	HourlyRate , SupervisorIndicator
Custom	Tenant-defined attributes with controls for choosing which apps can access the data.	Any custom attribute where selective access is needed.

Best Practice

HourlyRate and SupervisorIndicator are non-public (confidential) attributes: choose which apps can receive them. Public attributes such as Organization , Location and FunctionType (Microsoft_JobDiscipline) are shared with Microsoft 365 apps; the Dashboard filters depend on the attributes being uploaded, not on a Public setting.

Source: Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service (Microsoft Learn, updated 1 September 2026) defines public, confidential, and custom organizational data and app access controls.

4. Naming Conventions

Rule	Details
Use underscores, not spaces	Column names must not contain spaces. Use <code>Business_Unit</code> or <code>BusinessUnit</code> , not <code>Business Unit</code> .
No <code>Microsoft_</code> prefix for custom attributes	The <code>Microsoft_</code> prefix is reserved for system attributes. Custom columns using this prefix will cause validation errors.
Case sensitivity	Microsoft documents the required <code>Organization</code> header as case sensitive . Use consistent casing for all headers.
Maximum field size	Field values cannot exceed 128 KB.
Total attribute limit	Maximum of 105 total attributes allowed in the system, which includes the five required attributes (reserved system attributes + your custom attributes combined).
Avoid special characters	Use only ASCII letters, numbers, and underscores in headers. Microsoft’s own error table lists a wider set of symbols; follow the stricter rule.

5. Reserved Attribute Names

The following attribute names are reserved by the system and **cannot be used for custom attributes**. If you need a similar concept, use a different name (e.g., `Agency_Location` instead of `Location`).

Reserved Name (Legacy)	Reserved Name (M365 Admin Center)
<code>PersonId</code>	<code>Microsoft_PersonEmail</code>
<code>ManagerId</code>	<code>Microsoft_ManagerEmail</code>
<code>Organization</code>	<code>Microsoft_Organization</code>
<code>EffectiveDate</code>	N/A (UI-based)
<code>FunctionType</code>	<code>Microsoft_JobDiscipline</code>
<code>LevelDesignation</code>	<code>Microsoft_LevelDesignation</code>
<code>Location</code>	<code>Microsoft_CompanyOfficeLocation</code>
<code>HireDate</code>	<code>Microsoft_HireDate</code>
<code>HourlyRate</code>	<code>Microsoft_HourlyRate</code>
<code>Layer</code>	<code>Microsoft_Layer</code>
<code>SupervisorIndicator</code>	<code>Microsoft_SupervisorIndicator</code>
<code>WeeklyBadgeOnsiteDays</code>	<code>Microsoft_WeeklyBadgeOnsiteDays</code>

Custom attribute headers also cannot be Microsoft system fields (`PeopleHistoricalId` , `StartDate` , `EndDate` , `Domain` , `PopulationType` , `TimeZone` , `StandardTimeZone` , `WorkdayStart` , `WorkDayEnd` , `WeekendDays` , `InferredTeamSize` , `ObjectId` , `IsActive` , `MetricDate` , `PrimaryCollaborator_PersonId` , `SecondaryCollaborator_PersonId`) or start with `Microsoft_` .

Important

Any custom attribute name beginning with `Microsoft_` will be rejected during validation. If you need to add custom attributes with similar concepts, use your own naming convention (e.g., `Agency` , `CostCentre` , `Region`).

6. Update, Delete, and Historical Correction

Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service uses incremental merge. Upload only affected users and include attributes you intend to update. An omitted or blank value preserves the existing value; use the documented marker when a value must be deleted.

Data type / operation	Supported value or path
Delete string value	Two single quotes (' ') in CSV; three single quotes when editing through Excel
Delete integer value	-1
Delete email value	A nonexistent email in the tenant, for example noname@contoso.com
Delete date value	01-01-0001
Correct historical data	CSV Historical import with the appropriate File valid as of date; Microsoft documents this for Viva Insights data only
Restore Entra for Viva hierarchy attributes	Enable ManagerId and/or Organization under Configure Entra connection , then remove uploaded optional attributes no longer needed

No Dummy-Row Workaround

Do not use a one-row “Replace All” file as a general rollback. It can create an artificial hierarchy and disrupt filters, partitions, and reports. Use the supported operations above or Microsoft Support for a critical migration rollback.

Sources: Import and manage your organizational data with a .csv file — Update or make other changes and Make retroactive updates (Microsoft Learn, updated 27 August 2026); Use Microsoft Entra plus .csv files for parallel data uploads — FAQs (Last updated 7 July 2026).

7. Microsoft Learn References

Topic	Link
Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service	learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-365-apps/org-data-service/organizational-data
CSV import, update, delete, and historical correction	learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-365-apps/org-data-service/import/import-orgdata
Parallel Entra and uploaded data	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/entra-plus-csv-upload
Microsoft 365 Organizational Data Service — Attribute reference	learn.microsoft.com/microsoft-365-apps/org-data-service/import/orgdata-attributes
Organizational data in Viva Insights	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/org-data-overview
Prepare Organisational Data (CSV)	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/prepare-org-data
Validation Errors	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/admin/rules-validation-errors
Data Quality Page	learn.microsoft.com/viva/insights/advanced/analyst/data-quality-analyst-experience

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